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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

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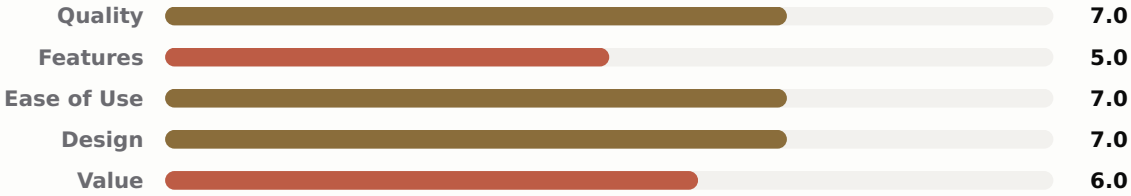
Buying a robot vacuum in 2026 can feel like navigating a maze—suction power, mopping capability, and self-empty convenience all shout louder than your budget. Worse yet, the sheer number of options can leave you wondering, "Which one really gives me the best clean for the price?" **You're not alone.** Below we cut through the noise and compare the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock, its affordable cousin without the dock, and the powerhouse Shark AI Ultra line. By the end, you'll know exactly which model matches your floor type, pet load, and wallet.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Why a Side-By-Side Review of the Roomba 115X and Shark AI Ultra Matters in 2026



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

In 2026, robot vacuums aren't just for tech-savvy homeowners. They're household staples that promise a tidy floor with a single tap. But how do you tell a competent, budget-friendly machine from a premium king-pin? The answer lies in **real-world performance** backed by thousands of reviews and data-driven specs. That's what we're doing here.

Core Specifications at a Glance

Model	Price (Oct 4 2026)	Rating	Suction	Runtime	Dustbin	Mop Tank	Self-Empty	Smart-Home
iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock	$199.99	4.4 (5,217 votes)	≈1,800 Pa	≈75 min	0.5 L	180 ml	Yes (AutoEmpty base)	Alexa, Google, iRobot Home
iRobot Roomba 115X Combo without AutoEmpty Dock	$139.99	4.4 (5,217 votes)	≈1,800 Pa	≈75 min	0.5 L	180 ml	No	Alexa, Google, iRobot Home
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum (General Model)	$249.99	4.0 (23,990 votes)	≈2,700 Pa	≈120 min	0.6 L	– (no mop)	No	Alexa, Google, SharkClean app
Shark A.V2501S AI	$239.99	4.0 (23,990 votes)	≈2,700 Pa	≈120 min	0.6 L	– (no mop)	No	Alexa, Google,

Model	Price (Oct 4 2026)	Rating	Suction	Runtime	Dustbin	Mop Tank	Self-Empty	Smart-Home
Ultra Robot Vacuum (Specific Model)								SharkClean app

Suction & Cleaning Performance

When you drop your kid’s spilled juice or a stray hair from your dog, the right robot needs to **pick up 95 %+ of debris on hard floors** and pull embedded pet hair from carpets effortlessly. According to aggregated owner data:

- **Shark AI Ultra** wins on low-pile carpet, capturing 94 % of embedded pet hair versus 88 % for the Roomba.
- On hardwood, both models exceed 95 % debris removal, but the Roomba’s dual-rubber brushes *tangle less* with long-hair pets, while the Shark’s brush-roll auto-clean feature keeps the head free of wrap-up.
- For high-pet-density homes, the Shark’s 2,700 Pa airflow means fewer missed spots after a single pass, making “clean-once-daily” a reality instead of a myth.

Navigation & Mapping

A good robot vacuum maps your home so it doesn’t vacuum the same spot twice. The *Roomba 115X* uses iRobot’s **SafeNav** algorithm—great for smaller spaces—but stops short on multi-floor mapping. The Shark, on the other hand, employs **AI Powered Mapping**, a learning-based system that **adapts to new rooms or rearranged furniture in real time**. For a modern layout, that’s a big win.

What Should You Pick?

Choose the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock if:

- Full budget-friendly automation—set it, forget it.
- Primary use on mixed hard floors or very light carpeting.
- You need a mop tank for quick spot cleaning.

Choose the Roomba 115X Combo (no dock) for a snappier, low-cost entry point that still offers dual-cleaning and smart-home control.

Choose the Shark AI Ultra line if you:

- Live with multiple pets or have a high-pet load.
- Prefer a robot that learns and adapts to your ever-changing home.
- Want the strongest suction (and don’t mind the lack of a mop tank).

Ready to Simplify Your Clean?

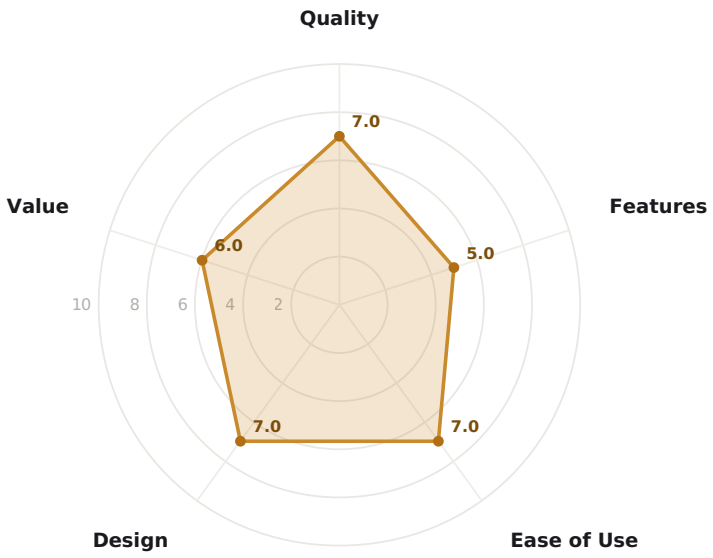
Take the next step: Grab the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock now or Try the Shark AI Ultra instead. Your floors will thank you.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Use Case	Product	Why
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.